

BUSINESS STRATEGY · KENYA
FIRST, AFRICA NEXT

KEJA AI

The strategy for turning verified-property infrastructure into the trust layer of African real estate: structural problems, layered revenue, three gated phases and a technology base whose costs shrink as its moat deepens.

Strategy document

A CHACADOM INVESTMENTS VENTURE

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KEJA AI · KEJA.APP

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1 Executive Summary

Keja AI exists to solve one problem: in African real estate, the person with the money knows the least about the asset. This strategy sets out how a small, capital-efficient team turns verified-property infrastructure into the trust layer through which Kenyan real estate is discovered, financed and transacted—and how it defends that position once incumbents notice.

The company thesis is structural. Property is Kenya's largest store of household wealth, its transaction volume is enormous, and its information environment is pre-digital: unverified titles, unexplainable prices, informal brokers, and a diaspora that sends money home hoping for the best. Portals solved advertising; nobody has solved verification, analysis and transaction support as one continuous, explainable layer. Keja AI is built to be that layer. The product already spans the full lifecycle—discover, verify, analyse, finance, invest, transact, manage—with an honesty mechanism (the public claims register) that keeps the company's promises auditable.

The strategy proceeds in three phases: prove the trust product with consumers and agents on top of a self-growing inventory; monetise the professionals and institutions who benefit most from verified demand; then become transactional infrastructure, earning fees where trust converts directly into completed deals. Each phase has explicit gates—no phase begins until its predecessor's metrics clear—and the engine is already unusually cheap to run: a static, edge-deployed application with an automated listing pipeline, no servers to babysit and no inventory to hand-key.

2 Vision, Mission and Operating Principles

Vision: a continent where any property can be trusted from a phone. Mission: verify every property, explain every number, and guide every transaction in African real estate.

- **Evidence over promises.** Every score is drillable to its factors; every statistic declares its sample size; the claims register keeps the product honest about its own capabilities.
- **Small surface, deep integrity.** Nine products, one trust engine—features ship only when they strengthen the spine, never as disconnected stunts.
- **Capital efficiency as strategy.** Static edge deployment, automated inventory growth and founder-led distribution mean the runway is measured in years, not months.
- **Local by default.** Trilingual product (English, Swahili, French), offline-capable installation for mid-range Android, WhatsApp-native sharing, and pricing denominated in shillings.

3 Problem and Opportunity

Three structural failures define the opportunity. Each is a tax on every transaction, and each is an information problem—exactly the kind software fixes.

Structural failure	What it costs	Keja's wedge
Title and identity opacity	Due diligence is manual, slow and expert-gated; fraud and disputes are endemic	Property Passport with verification status, encumbrances, rates and zoning in one identity document
Price and yield opacity	Buyers negotiate blind; investors cannot compare opportunities credibly	Valuation bands, Investment Scores and yield answers computed live from inventory with sample sizes
Distance risk (diaspora)	Billions in annual remittances meet zero inspection ability	Remote verification, timezone-aware service, Deal Analyst screening with on-device document processing

Table 3.1 — The three failures, their cost, and the product wedge for each.

The addressable market is layered. Consumer transactions (buying, renting, managing) supply volume and habit. Professional supply (agents, landlords, developers, valuers) supplies recurring revenue. Institutional demand (banks, SACCOs, pension funds, insurers) supplies contracts, data licensing and mortgage-scale economics. Kenya is the beachhead because it combines deep digital payments rails, an active diaspora, a mortgage market small enough to be upgradeable, and land-records digitisation momentum at government level. The regional expansion logic (Rwanda, Tanzania, Uganda, Nigeria) reuses the entire engine—only the data and the partners change.

4 Competitive Landscape and Moat

Incumbents are strong at what they already do. The moat is that none of them are structurally able to do what Keja does without becoming a different company.

Player class	Examples	Their strength	Their structural gap
Listing portals	BuyRentKenya, Jiji, PigiaMe	Traffic, inventory breadth, brand familiarity	Monetise attention; verification would slow their listing flywheel and cannibalise ad revenue
Agency / data houses	Hass Consult, Knight Frank	Institutional trust, proprietary indices, prime-mandate deal flow	Serve the top of the market at bespoke prices; no consumer-grade self-serve trust product

Player class	Examples	Their strength	Their structural gap
Government rails	Lands ministry records, eCitizen	Authoritative source data as digitisation proceeds	Records, not products: no scoring, no analysis, no transaction guidance
Informal channel	Brokers, family networks	Distribution reach and cultural embeddedness	Zero tooling, zero accountability, zero scale economics

Table 4.1 — Competitor map: why the trust layer stays open.

Keja's defensible assets compound: the verification methodology and its evidence trail (hard to fake, slow to copy), the Auto-Pilot inventory pipeline that grows supply while the team sleeps, the explainable-scoring engine whose outputs partners can audit, the claims-register discipline that converts honesty into brand, and a distribution cost structure near zero. Where portals must keep listing volume frictionless, Keja's revenue depends on listing quality—verification depth is not a feature we can quietly drop, which is precisely why it can become our identity.

5 Business Model and Revenue Streams

Revenue follows trust depth: consumers pay little, professionals pay monthly, institutions pay for capability. The sequence matters—each stream funds and de-risks the next.

Stream	Who pays	Model	Phase
Verified listing fees	Owners, agents, developers	Per-listing verification fee; volume tiers for agents	Phase 1-2
Pro workspace SaaS	Agents, valuers, property managers	Monthly subscription for pipelines, analytics and branded passports	Phase 2
Finance referrals	Banks, KMRC-originated lenders	Commission on qualified mortgage introductions from the eligibility engine	Phase 2-3
Transaction services	Buyers and sellers	Fee on milestone-managed transactions (escrow-adjacent, partner-operated)	Phase 3
Data licensing	Banks, insurers, researchers, development institutions	Subscription to aggregated, anonymised market intelligence	Phase 3
Institutional verification API	Lenders, REITs, insurers	Per-call verification and scoring for underwriting workflows	Phase 3

Table 5.1 — Revenue streams, payers and the phase each activates.

Two disciplines govern monetisation. First, the consumer experience never paywalls trust basics—the Trust Score and Passport remain free because they are the growth engine, not the product. Second, anything

touching client money operates through licensed partners (banks, conveyancers, escrow providers) in Phase 3; Keja sells coordination and verification, not unregulated custody. The tokenization module remains in trial mode with fictional assets until Capital Markets Authority engagement defines a compliant path.

6 Go-To-Market Strategy

Three phases with explicit gates. The companion marketing playbook and partner proposals document execute the details; this chapter fixes the logic.

Phase	Thesis	Gate to advance
1—Prove (months 0-6)	Consumers and early agents adopt the trust layer; supply grows through the free verification tier and Auto-Pilot inventory; WhatsApp-native sharing compounds reach	3,000 installs; 100 partnering agents; 20% month-over-month verified-listing view growth
2—Monetise (months 6-15)	Pro subscriptions, listing fees and the first bank referral pilots convert proven attention into recurring revenue; two institutional data pilots begin	150 paying pros; first referral revenue; churn under 5% monthly
3—Institutional ise (months 15-24)	Verification API and data licensing embed Keja in underwriting and research workflows; transaction services launch with licensed partners	Two signed institutional contracts; transaction revenue live

Table 6.1 — Phase theses and advancement gates.

7 Technology as Strategy

The engineering choices are not overhead—they are the strategy. Three choices carry the business logic.

- **Zero marginal cost of distribution.** A statically exported PWA installs on any Android or iOS device without app-store friction and works offline—a decisive advantage where data is metered and devices are mid-range. Every user can hold the entire product for the cost of one page load.
- **Self-growing inventory.** The Auto-Pilot pipeline ingests, enriches, dedupes and quality-gates listings every six hours without human effort, so supply scales with compute, not headcount—and every ingested listing strengthens the data asset that Phase 3 monetises.
- **Honesty as an architecture.** The claims register, sample-size declarations and drillable scores are product features, not legal disclaimers. They make trust auditable by users and partners alike, which is the precondition for the institutional revenue phase.

8 Twenty-Four-Month Roadmap

The roadmap sequences capability behind the phase gates—no feature outruns its monetisation logic.

Horizon	Product	Commercial	Infrastructure
0-6 months	Trust Score refinements from user feedback; saved-search alerts; Deal Analyst language coverage; partner-branded passports	Free agent verification tier; first 100 agents; referral programme	Product analytics instrumentation; keja.app domain live; PWA polish on real devices
6-12 months	Pro workspace GA; landlord tooling depth; area-guide coverage to 25 neighbourhoods	Pro subscriptions; listing fees; two bank referral pilots	Backend graduation: accounts API, server-side profiles, real-time inventory writes
12-24 months	Verification API; institutional dashboards; transaction milestones with licensed escrow partners	Data licensing; institutional contracts; transaction fee revenue	Regional readiness: multi-currency, multi-jurisdiction data model, francophone entry

Table 8.1 — Capability roadmap aligned to phase gates.

9 Risk Register

The strategy's honest failure modes, each with a designed mitigation rather than a hope.

Risk	Severity	Mitigation
Portal copies verification claims	High	They can copy the words, not the evidence trail; audit-ability and the claims register become the comparison test
Title-verification partnerships stall	High	Evidence panels degrade gracefully (declared status, not fake certainty); professional panel fills the gap commercially
Consumer monetisation lags	Medium	Cost structure tolerates long consumer runway; professional revenue does not depend on consumer conversion
Regulatory reclassification (tokenization)	Medium	Trial mode with fictional assets until CMA engagement concludes; module isolation means the rest of the product is unaffected
Key-person concentration	Medium	Documented engineering dossier, CI-gated quality, this strategy document and the repo itself reduce bus factor
Data quality drift in Auto-Pilot	Medium	Quality gate plus human review queue already in the pipeline; pending-review queue exists in the data model

Table 9.1 — Strategic risks and designed mitigations.

10 Team and Operations

Keja AI operates as a Chacadom Investments venture with a deliberately small permanent team: product-engineering, trust operations (verification and partner evidence), and growth. Verification specialists are contracted per-relation as volume scales, which keeps fixed costs flat while trust capacity flexes. The operating cadence is weekly against the marketing playbook's metrics, monthly against the phase gates, and quarterly against this document—each review asks one question: did the evidence change? Strategy here is a living constraint system, not a slide deck, and its two enforcement mechanisms are the claims register the product carries and the phase gates the finance function respects.